



A prompt change is a production change

RELEASE MANIFEST

commentary-release 2026.10

one per monthly cycle · illustrative values

Prompt set	v14
Drafting model	pinned, dated version temperature 0
Fallback model	pinned, dated version
Embedding and reranker	match the index's model-version tag
Retrieval top-k	8
Tool list	read-only attribution engine, approved market notes
Guardrail policy	v6
Eval threshold set	v3

THE SIGNAL

Rollback time

from the decision to revert to the previous approved version serving all traffic: **minutes, not a release cycle**. Drill it twice a year.

HOW A CHANGE REACHES PRODUCTION

- 1

Pull request
diff of prompt text and every manifest field
- ↓
- 2

Second approver
investment risk; authors never approve their own change
- ↓
- 3

Eval gate
regression suite, numeric and style checks; a failure blocks the merge
- ↓
- 4

Tagged release
frozen for the month-end cycle
- ↓
- 5

Registry label moves
only the pipeline moves "production"
- ↓
- 6

Trace stamped
every draft names the manifest and prompt version

NEVER

A production prompt edited in a web console

outside the pull-request path, written, approved and released by one person